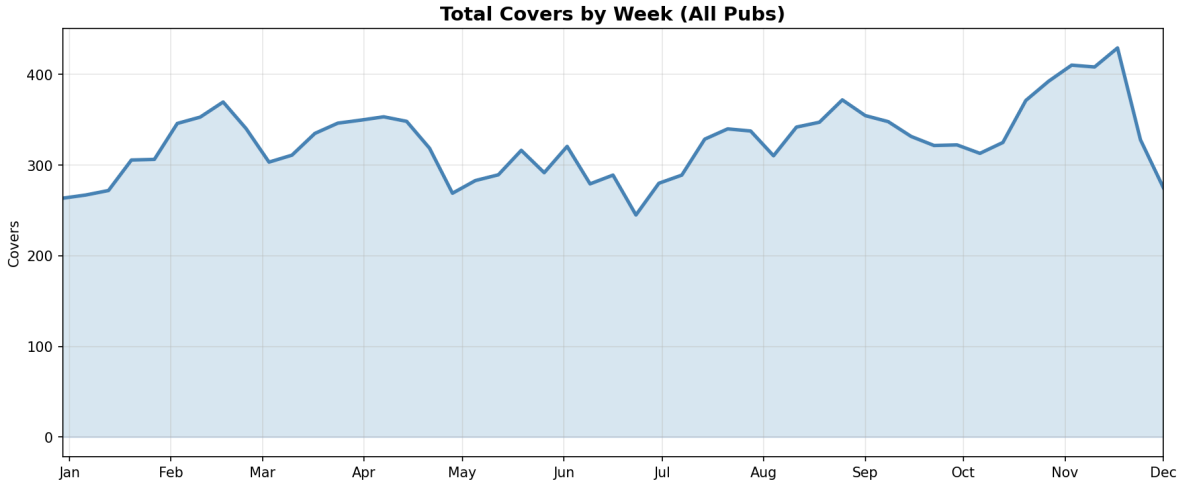
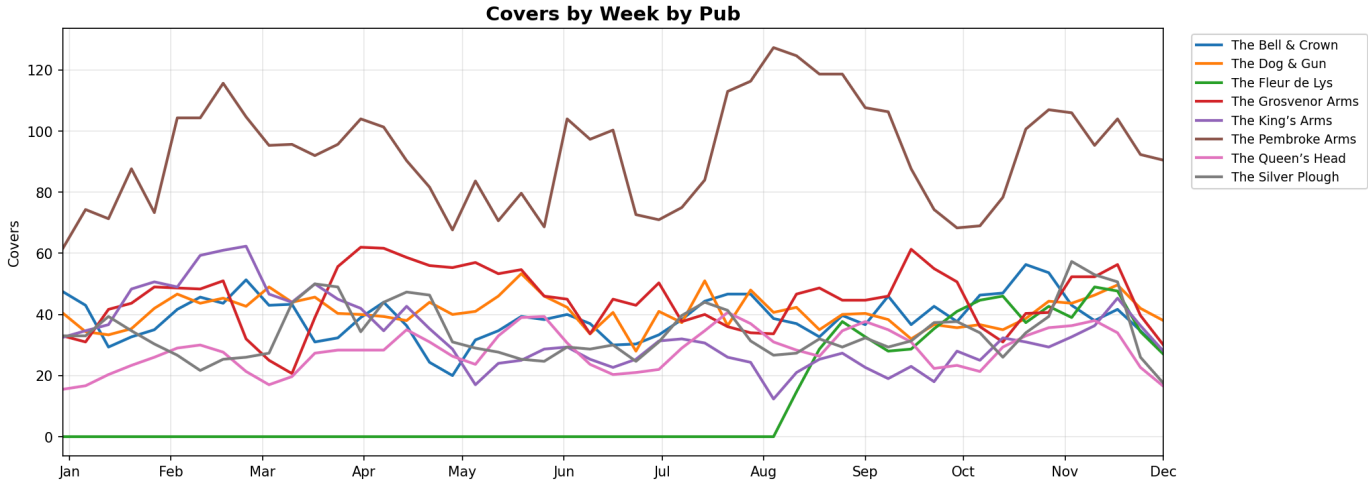
Chickpea Pubs - Covers Analysis 2025

Weekly Covers (Jan - Dec 2025)





Covers by Week

Data source: SevenRooms API | **Period:** 1 Jan - 4 Dec 2025 | **Total covers:** 15,910

Key Findings

Overall Performance

- **Average weekly covers:** ~325 across all pubs
- **Peak weeks:** Late October / Early November (~440 covers)
- **Quietest period:** Mid-June (~210 covers)

Seasonal Trends

Season	Trend
Jan-Feb	Steady growth from 270 to 370
Mar-May	Plateau around 320-350
Jun-Jul	Summer dip to 250-280

Season	Trend
Aug-Nov	Strong recovery, peak at 440+
Dec	Early signs of decline

Pub Performance

Top performer: The Pembroke Arms - Consistently 100-130 covers/week - 2-3x the volume of other pubs - Peak in Aug-Sep (~130/week)

Mid-tier (30-60 covers/week): - The Silver Plough - The King's Arms - The Bell & Crown - The Grosvenor Arms - The Dog & Gun - The Queen's Head

Low/No activity: - The Fleur de Lys (minimal SevenRooms bookings)

Insights

1. **Summer requires marketing focus** - June-July shows consistent dip across all pubs
2. **Pembroke Arms carries the group** - Accounts for ~35% of total covers
3. **Q4 is strongest** - Oct-Nov peak suggests seasonal dining demand
4. **Growth trend** - Year showing overall upward trajectory (+50% from Jan to Nov peak)

November 2025 - Bookings & Guest Feedback

Overview

Metric	Value
Total bookings	4,063
Total covers	14,872
Feedback responses	361
Average rating	**4.72/5**
5-star reviews	81%
Would recommend	95%

Category Scores

Category	Score
Ambience	4.77/5
Service	4.72/5
Drinks	4.70/5
Food	4.63/5

Food scores lowest - consistent theme in comments around temperature, portion presentation, and value for money.

Feedback by Pub

The King's Arms ⭐ Top Rated

Rating: 4.88/5 | 43 responses | 91% 5-star

> *"Very good service from Izzie and delightful food and ambiance…why haven't we been before!"*

> *"Very friendly and helpful staff"*

Strong performance on service (4.82) and food (4.71). Minimal negative feedback.

The Silver Plough

Rating: 4.74/5 | 61 responses | 82% 5-star | 340 bookings, 1,384 covers

> *"Everything here is first class. Friendly knowledgeable staff and the food is sublime."*

> *"Only very little things like the coffee being served in a mug not a cup…"*

Consistent performer. Minor feedback on presentation details.

The Fleur de Lys

Rating: 4.74/5 | 73 responses | 81% 5-star | 626 bookings, 1,993 covers

> *"Great experience already booked again for next weekend!"*

Areas to address: > *"We were a party of 11 people, we only ordered mains and waited way over an hour for our food"* (2/5)

> *"Food service could have been quicker. We waited over half an hour…"* (4/5)

Theme: Wait times for larger parties need attention.

The Queen's Head

Rating: 4.72/5 | 43 responses | 86% 5-star | 296 bookings, 992 covers

> *“Food, service and ambience PERFECT. We will be back!”*

Areas to address: > *“The 12.5% service charge is significant - although we had to go up and order ourselves”* (3/5)

Theme: Service charge perception when table service is limited.

The Bell & Crown

Rating: 4.68/5 | 78 responses | 78% 5-star | 528 bookings, 1,805 covers

> *“Charming staff”*

Areas to address: > *“The food was disappointing, for the price you would expect better presentation”* (3/5)

> *“Cornish bitter was cloudy we had to take back, new barrel much better”* (4/5)

Theme: Food presentation and drink quality consistency.

The Grosvenor Arms

Rating: 4.63/5 | 63 responses | 75% 5-star

> *“Fantastic, genuine staff. Beautiful food and drinks. Warm and cosy atmosphere.”*

> *“Amazing food, friendly and happy staff and beautiful cosy pub!”*

Areas to address: > *“The quality for the price didn’t meet expectations the beef was very very very rare”* (1/5)

> *“The food could have been hotter”* (4/5)

> *“Could do with a baby changing facility”* (5/5)

Themes: Food temperature/cooking, facilities for families, value perception.

Key Themes from November Feedback

Theme	Frequency	Impact
Wait times (large parties)	Medium	High
Food temperature	Medium	Medium
Value for money	Low	High

Theme	Frequency	Impact
Staff friendliness	High (positive)	High
Ambience	High (positive)	Medium

Consistent Issues (2025 Full Year)

Based on analysis of 570 feedback responses, the following issues appear repeatedly across multiple guests and venues. These are not isolated incidents.

1. Wait Times for Food (13 complaints)

Affected pubs: Fleur de Lys, Bell & Crown, Queen's Head, Silver Plough, King's Arms

This is the most frequently cited issue, particularly for larger parties.

> *"We were a party of 11 people, we only ordered mains and waited way over an hour for food. Service was good but no one came to apologise for the wait."* — Fleur de Lys, 2/5

> *"We waited an hour for our food which was too long"* — King's Arms, 3/5

> *"Booked table for Sunday lunch. Order taken straight away but then waited nearly an hour"* — Queen's Head, 1/5

> *"Took too long to serve. Requested condiments arrived as meal was finishing."* — Bell & Crown, 2/5

Pattern: Issue is most acute at Fleur de Lys and Bell & Crown. Large party bookings (8+) are particularly affected.

2. Service Charge Perception (6 complaints)

Affected pubs: Bell & Crown, Queen's Head, Silver Plough

Guests question the 12.5% service charge when they perceive table service as limited.

> *"The 12.5% service charge is significant - although we had to go up and ask for condiments - there was no check in to see if everything was ok"* — Queen's Head, 3/5

> *"The service charge added to the bill… £25… was not appreciated. I would tip if I was happy with the service but not automatically"* — Silver Plough, 3/5

> *"Service charge disproportionate to service received"* — Bell & Crown, 2/5

Pattern: Issue arises when guests feel they had to self-serve (ordering at bar, fetching condiments) while still paying full service charge.

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3. Food Temperature & Cooking (9 complaints)

Affected pubs: Silver Plough, Grosvenor Arms, Bell & Crown, Fleur de Lys

Mix of overcooking and dishes arriving lukewarm.

> *"The calves liver was overcooked today. That's a first for the Silver Plough"* — Silver Plough, 4/5

> *"Schnitzel overcooked and rather greasy"* — Silver Plough, 4/5

> *"The trout was ever so slightly overdone"* — Grosvenor Arms, 4/5

> *"Pie crust slightly burnt"* — Bell & Crown, 4/5

> *"The meat was supposed to be tender but not today"* — Silver Plough, 3/5

Pattern: Overcooking is more common than undercooking. Silver Plough has the most cooking consistency feedback.

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4. Value for Money (6 complaints)

Affected pubs: Grosvenor Arms, Bell & Crown, Fleur de Lys

Guests feel quality doesn't always match price point.

> *"The quality for the price didn't meet expectations… expensive for 3 meals £100"* — Grosvenor Arms, 1/5

> *"For the price you would expect better presentation & garnish"* — Bell & Crown, 3/5

> *"Menu lacked some simpler dishes - everything is heavy or rich"* — Fleur de Lys, 3/5

Pattern: Often linked to other issues (wait times, cooking problems) which amplify the perception of poor value.

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5. Portion Sizes & Presentation (6 complaints)

Affected pubs: Bell & Crown (most mentions)

> *"Portion sizes exceptionally small"* — Bell & Crown, 2/5

> *"We thought the portions for the starter and main courses were slightly small"* — Bell & Crown, 4/5

> *"For the price you would expect better presentation & garnish"* — Bell & Crown, 3/5

Pattern: Bell & Crown has the most portion size complaints. May need menu/plating review.

Summary of Action Areas

Issue	Frequency	Priority	Primary Venues
Wait times	13	**High**	Fleur de Lys, Bell & Crown
Service charge	6	Medium	Bell & Crown, Queen's Head
Food cooking	9	Medium	Silver Plough, Grosvenor Arms
Value perception	6	Medium	Grosvenor Arms, Bell & Crown
Portion sizes	6	Low	Bell & Crown

Recommendations

1. **Kitchen timing review** - Audit ticket times at Fleur de Lys and Bell & Crown, especially for parties 8+
2. **Service charge policy** - Consider removing or reducing when table service is limited, or improve communication
3. **Cooking consistency** - Refresher training on protein cooking temps at Silver Plough
4. **Bell & Crown review** - Multiple issues (wait times, portions, presentation) suggest broader operational review needed
5. **Family facilities** - Add baby changing at Grosvenor Arms (requested in positive feedback)

Generated: December 2025